In animated movies where they use a still image but add movement by scrolling or zooming in or out. Does that technique have a name. Is there any best practices for do this. How can you match dialog and story boards to this technique

Yes—the common name is the **Ken Burns effect**: adding apparent movement to a still image by panning across it, zooming in or out, or combining those moves. In animation software, you will often see it described simply as "pan and zoom" or "camera movement over still artwork."[1]

For what you're describing, the useful approach is to treat the image like a small set: decide where the viewer should look, when they should look there, and how the dialogue motivates that change.

Related terms

Term	What it describes
Pan / tilt	Moving the framing horizontally / vertically across artwork.
Zoom in / out	Moving from a wider view to a detail, or revealing more of the image.
Parallax animation	Separating foreground, characters, and background into layers that move at different speeds, creating apparent depth.
Animatic	A timed version of the storyboard, usually using still panels, rough dialogue, and simple camera moves to test the sequence.

Pan-and-zoom terminology describes the movement; parallax describes a layered depth technique; an animatic describes the planning format rather than the finished visual style.[2] [3] [1]

Best practices

The central principle is to give each move a storytelling purpose—not just keep the image moving. Pans and zooms can direct attention or reveal information; restraint helps keep those effects from competing with the story.[1] [2]

Here are practical guidelines I'd use:

Storytelling goal	Suggested treatment
Establish a location	Start wide, hold briefly, then move toward the relevant area.
Emphasize an important realization	Slowly tighten the framing on the character or relevant detail.
Reveal a surprise	Start with a restricted view, then pan or zoom out to expose new information.
Connect two subjects	Move from one to the other when the dialogue shifts focus.
Let a line or reaction land	Hold the frame still rather than automatically adding movement.

Additional production recommendations:

- Plan both the starting and ending compositions. Each should work as an intentional image.
- Leave artwork beyond the visible frame so movement does not expose empty edges.
- Check the tightest crop at delivery resolution; a wide image may look good initially but become soft when enlarged.
- Favor simple moves. A subtle pan plus a slight zoom may be enough; repeated direction changes can feel like drifting.
- Use gentle acceleration and deceleration when they suit the shot, but test the result rather than applying easing mechanically.
- Do not stretch one image beyond what it can communicate. If the story requires a changed expression, physical action, or a different viewpoint, plan another drawing or animation element.

These are suggested working rules, not fixed speed or duration standards—the right timing depends on the performance and what the viewer must notice.

How to match dialogue and storyboards

The bridge is an animatic: place storyboard images on a timeline alongside recorded or temporary dialogue, then test shot lengths, cuts, pans, and zooms before finishing the artwork. This is specifically what animatics are used to evaluate: how images, sound, motion, and timing work together. [3]

1. Break dialogue into story beats

Rather than assigning one picture to each sentence, mark the points where something changes:

- New information appears.
- The speaker’s attention changes.
- A character realizes something.
- A detail becomes important.
- A pause or reaction needs space.

Storyboards can carry dialogue, action descriptions, camera directions, and technical notes together, so those beats become explicit production instructions. [4]

For example, consider this invented line:

> “I thought the house was empty … until I saw the light upstairs.”

That contains several possible visual beats: the house, apparent emptiness, the hesitation, and the upstairs light.

2. Use recorded speech as your timing reference

My recommended workflow is:

1. Record a scratch performance—or generate a temporary voice track.
2. Mark important words, pauses, and changes in delivery.
3. Place rough storyboard panels against those markers.
4. Add only the movement needed to guide attention.
5. Watch the sequence with sound, then revise its timing.

Rough dialogue is sufficient for an animatic; you do not need a final voice performance to begin testing. But if the performance later changes, revisit the shot timing.[3]

3. Choose the relationship between words and images

You do not have to reveal everything exactly when it is spoken. As a creative timing choice, you can:

- Reveal before the line: the audience notices the light before the character mentions it.
- Reveal with the line: the light enters the frame as “light” is spoken.
- Reveal after the line: the voice creates anticipation, followed by the visual confirmation.

For a first pass, I’d try revealing with the key phrase, then compare earlier and later versions in the animatic.

4. Storyboard the start and end of each move

For a moving shot, show the opening composition and the ending composition, and annotate the direction. Camera arrows plus a written description communicate the intended move more clearly than either alone.[5]

A useful shot record is:

```
Shot ID:
Dialogue / audio cue:
Story purpose:
Start composition:
End composition:
Movement:
Start cue:
Arrival cue:
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Hold / cut:
Required artwork or layers:
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Example: one illustration supporting a line

Here is a proposed animatic plan—not a prescribed timing formula:

Beat	Audio	Framing / movement	Purpose
Establish	“I thought the house was empty…”	Wide view of the house; hold or use a very slight push-in.	Let the audience understand the location.
Anticipation	Pause	Begin moving toward the upper floor, without exposing the light yet.	Make the pause visually meaningful.
Reveal	“…until I saw the light…”	Bring the illuminated window into view.	Connect the key information to the spoken phrase.
Confirmation	“…upstairs.”	Settle on the window and hold.	Give the audience time to register the discovery.

To build this with one still, the illustration would need a usable wide composition, enough detail around the upstairs window, and room for the planned camera path.

The workflow I’d recommend is: script → scratch dialogue → rough storyboard → timed animatic → revised artwork → final camera moves. The important distinction is that the storyboard plans what the viewer sees, while the animatic tests when they see it.[4] [3]

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1. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ken_Burns_effect
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